

Speeding up reactions

Cooking makes carrots softer because the heat causes a chemical reaction. Chopping carrots into small bits speeds up the reaction because it increases the area of contact between the carrots and the hot water.



Sliced carrots cook faster than whole carrots.

Glow in the dark

Light sticks glow in the dark thanks to a chemical reaction that releases energy as light. You can slow down this reaction by putting a light stick in a fridge, which makes it last longer.



Hands on

Ask an adult to boil some red cabbage and save the coloured water. Let the water cool. Then add acid (vinegar) or alkali (bicarbonate of soda) and watch for a spectacular change of colour!



Soda volcano

If you drop mints into a bottle of fizzy drink, the drink turns to foam and explodes out in an instant. This is a physical change rather than a chemical reaction. The rough surface of the mints helps gas, dissolved in the drink, to turn into bubbles much more quickly than it normally would.

